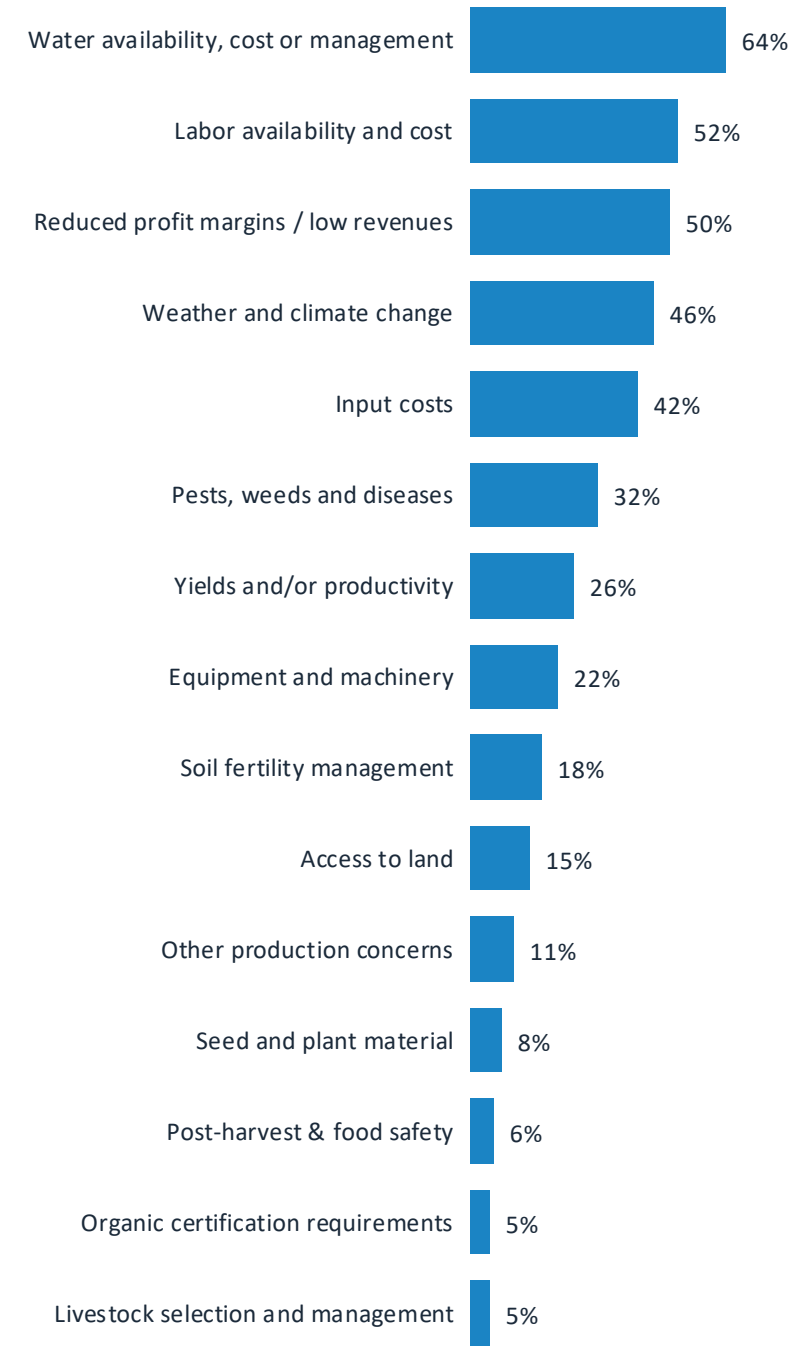
Latino Farmers in the U.S.: Survey Results

Disclaimer:
All logos, names, and figures shown in this presentation have been masked, removed, or replaced with sample data to protect confidentiality and ensure data privacy.

Primary Concerns (Q6, Q8, Q10, Q16, Q17)

Q6. Top Production Concerns

n=131



Q6. Notes:

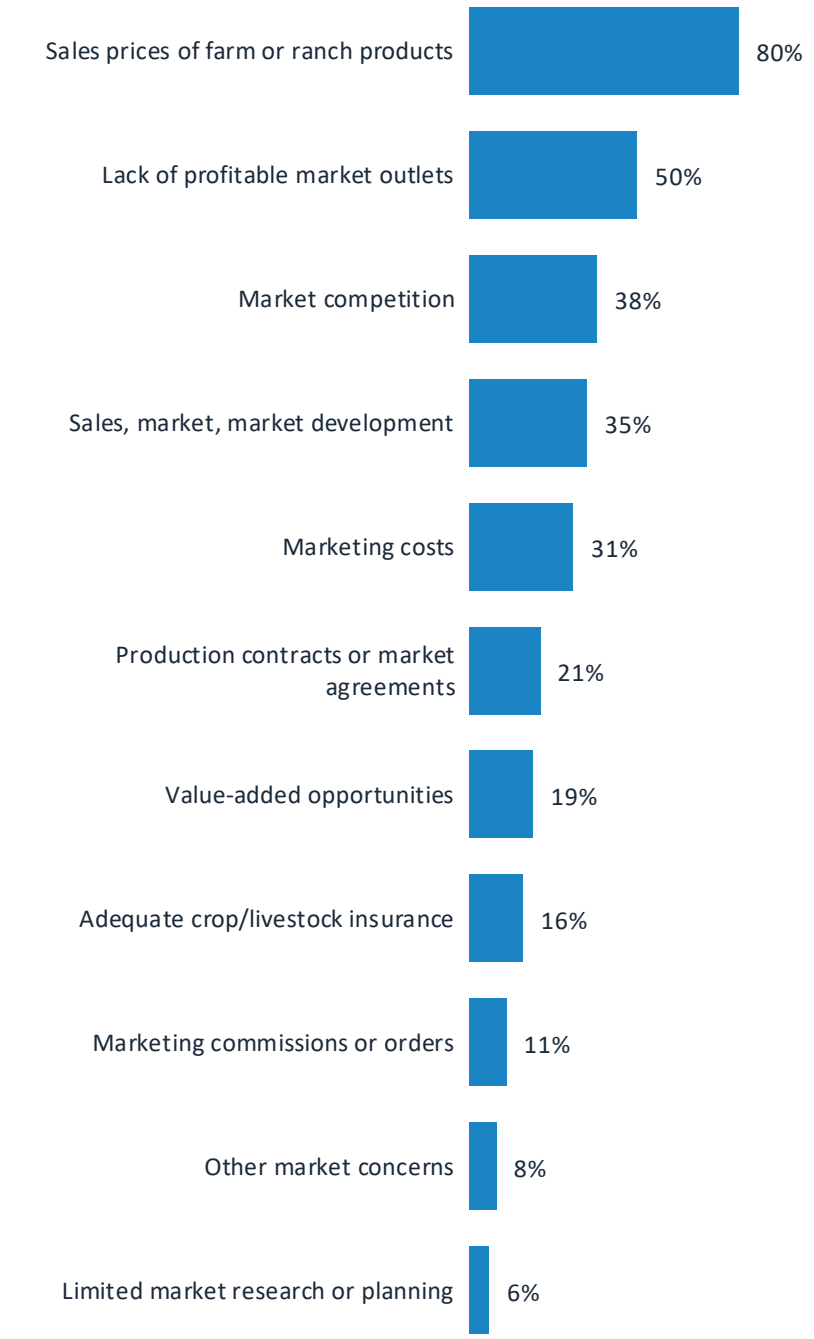
Labor came up a lot across the open-ended answers.

Other Concerns:

- *Foreign competition*
- *Government regulations*
- *Labor costs*
- *Labor shortage*
- *Logistics*
- *Mandated workman's comp*
- *New pesticide rules*
- *Qualified workers*

Q8. Top Market Related Concerns

n=131



Q8. Notes:

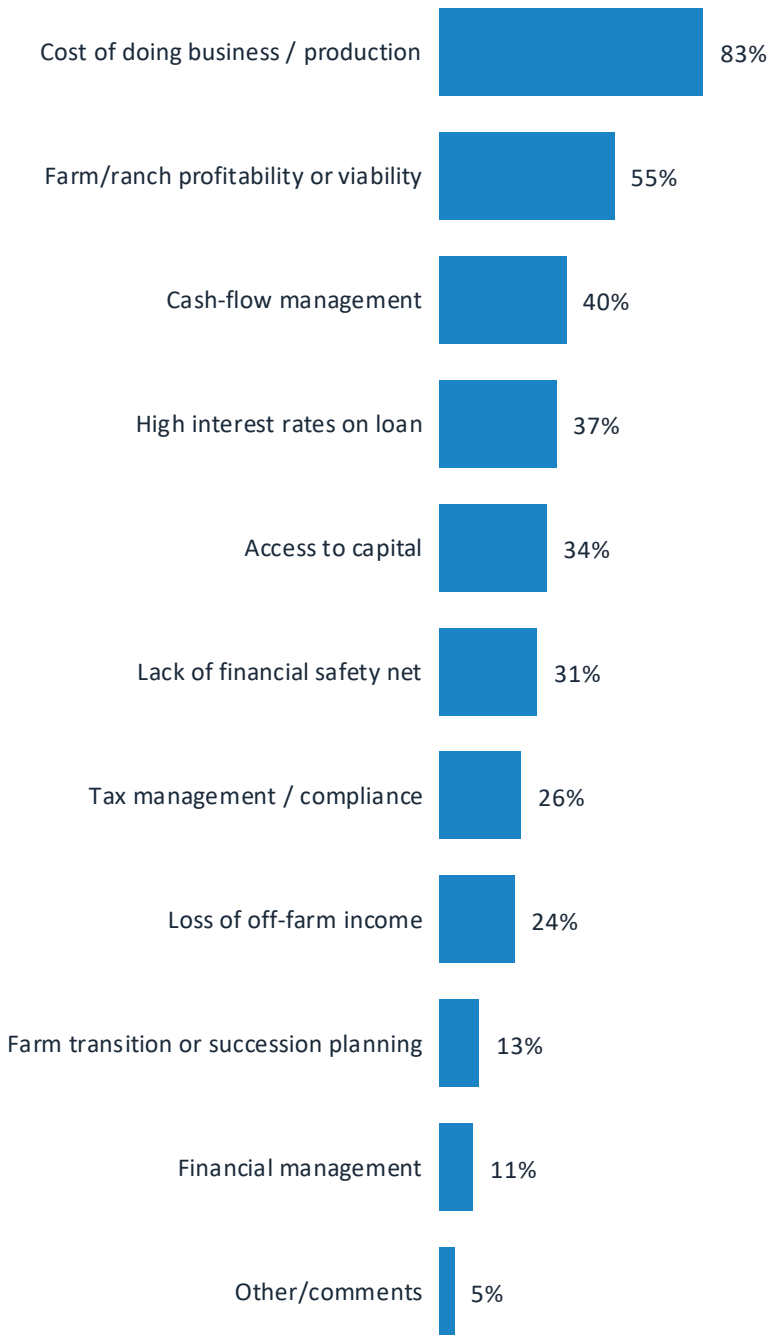
Other Concerns:

- *Over regulation*
- *Imports*
- *Cheap imported fruit*
- *Customers moving out of the area*
- *California regulations*
- *Packing house honesty*
- *Retail markets are consolidating*
- *Patented GMOs controlling seed*
- *Product available sooner elsewhere*

Primary Concerns

Q10. Top Financial Concerns

n=130



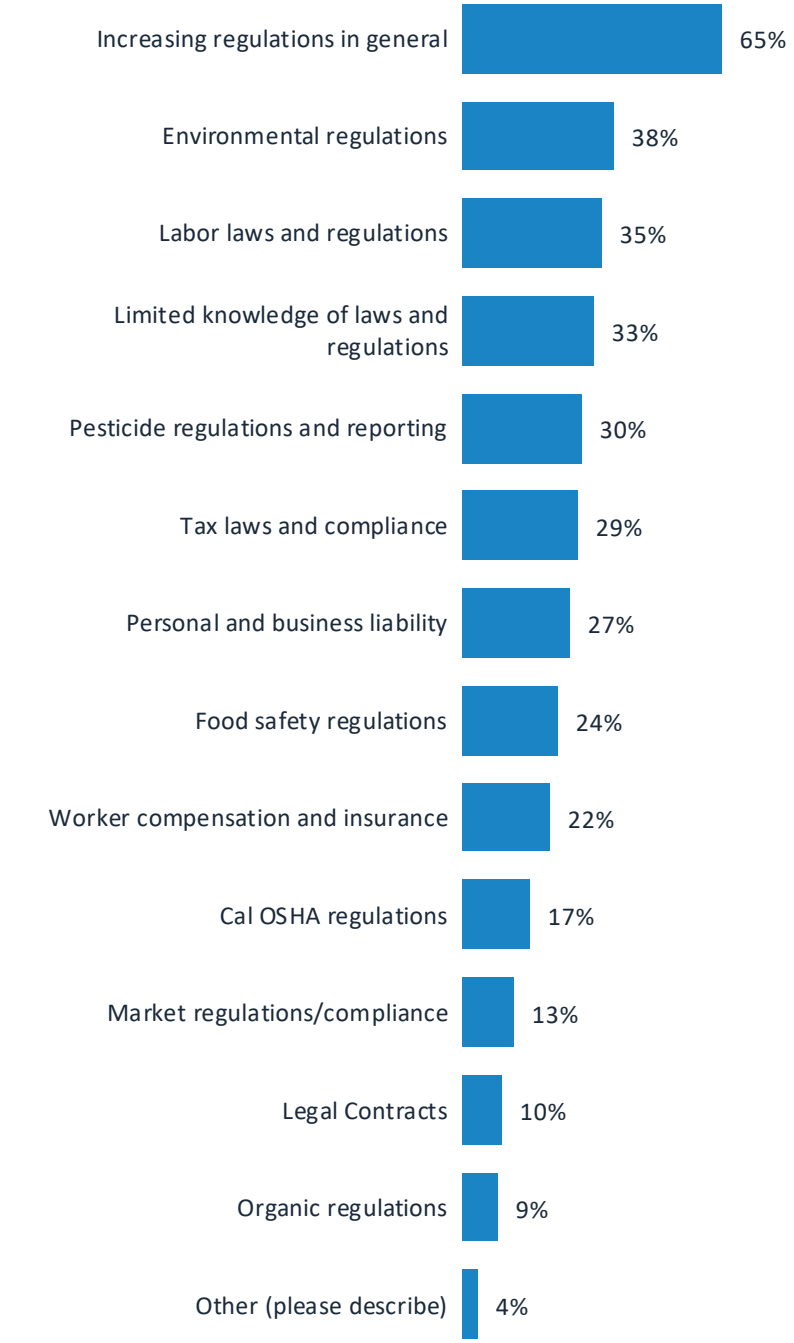
Q10. Notes:

Other Concerns:

- *Hard to make money on small acreage*
- *Having all livestock butchered at one site*
- *Need to promote consumption of local produce*
- *Small farms have difficulty accessing credit*
- *Water regulatory costs*

Q16-Top Legal Concerns

n=126



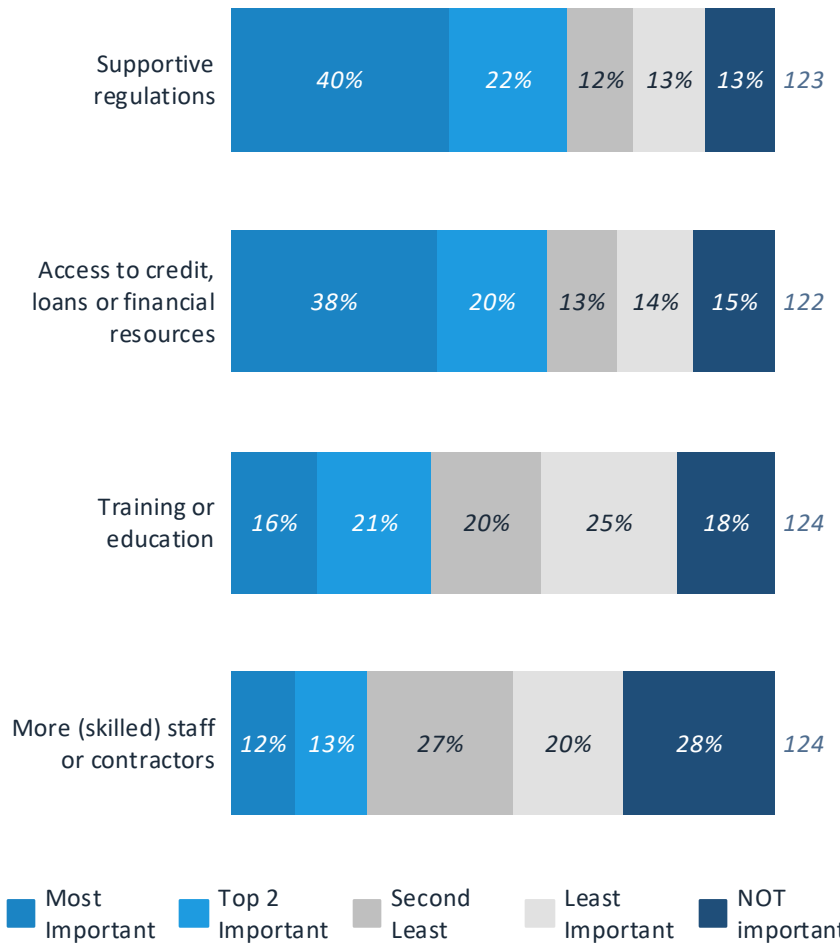
Q16. Notes:

Other Concerns:

- *Being unaware of which laws apply to us*
- *Liability waivers*
- *Protection of apex predators*
- *Racism*

Addressing Primary Concerns (Q7, Q9, Q11)

Q7. Needs to address PRODUCTION concerns.

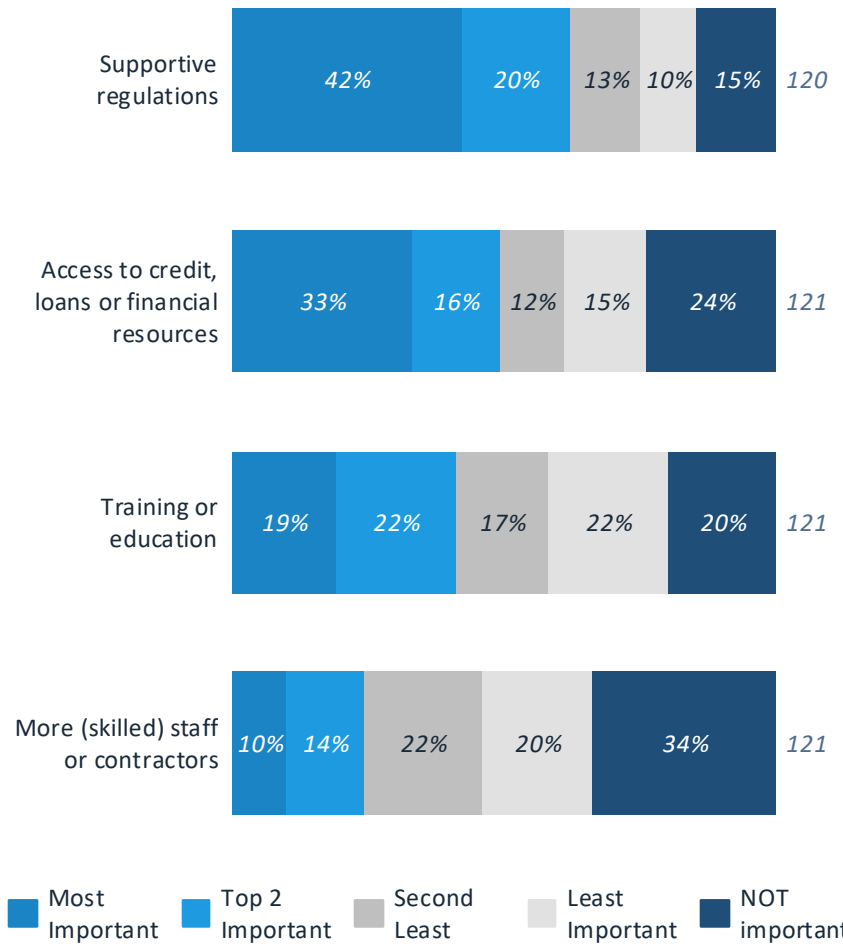


Q7. Notes:

Other Methods (n=20):

- *Mandated workman's comp reform*
- *Ability to obtain an agricultural visa*
- *Price controls on rates*
- *Energy and input costs*
- *Cost of packaging materials*
- *Resources available*
- *More support from the state*
- *More promotion*

Q9. Needs to address MARKET concerns.



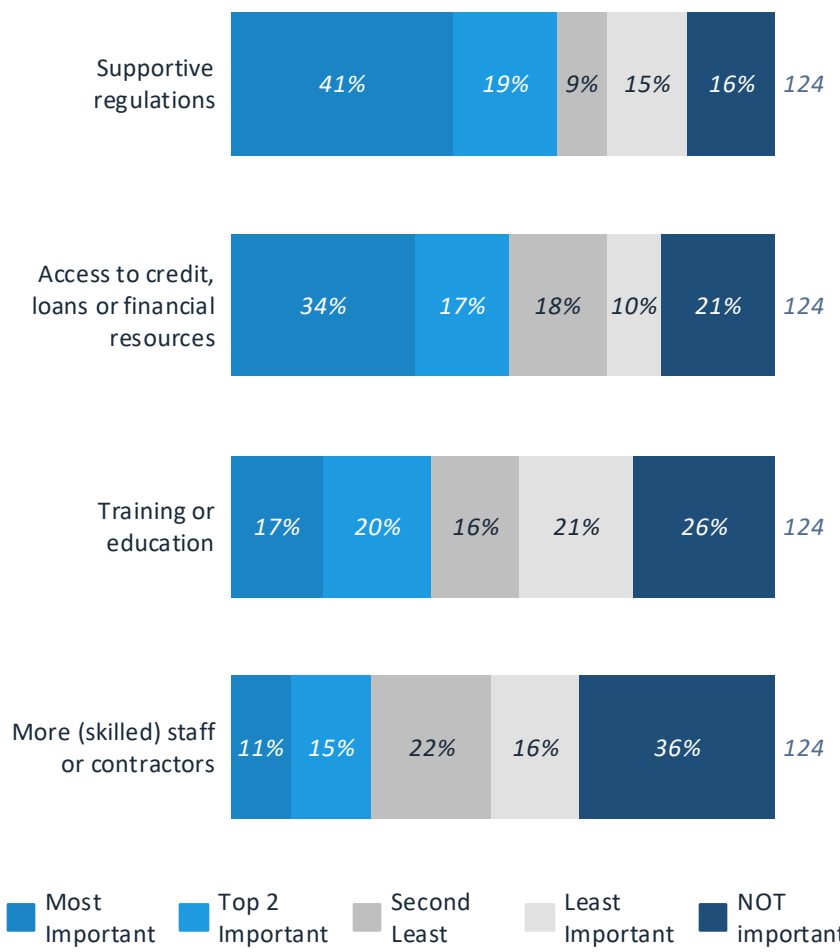
Q9. Notes:

Other Methods (n=20):

- *Access to farm-to-table programs*
- *Control of working inputs*
- *Easier to buy bulk contracts*
- *Food safety requirements*
- *Handler transparency*
- *Improve the marketing of local produce*
- *Increased access to export markets*
- *Insurance to help when prices drop*
- *Maintain a price floor*

Addressing Primary Concerns

Q11. Needs to address FINANCIAL concerns.



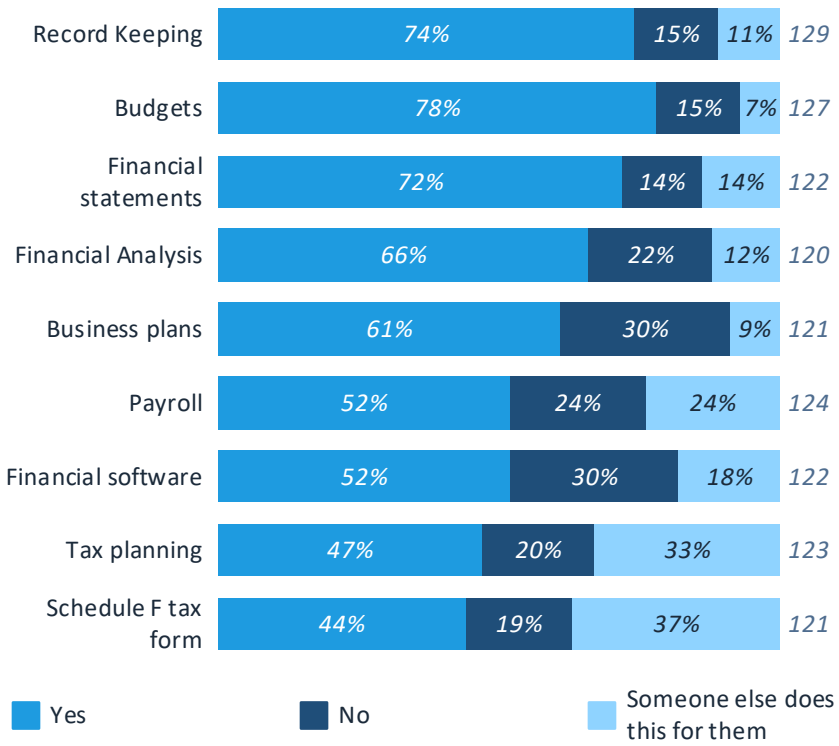
Q11. Notes:

Other Methods (n=20):

- *Better crop insurance coverage*
- *Enforcement of regulations*
- *Establish long-term relationships with buyers*
- *Forming a group of growers*
- *Good prices and good crops*
- *Grants for small farmers*
- *I work alone so as to not lose control*
- *Increased international markets*
- *Less onerous regulations*

Financial Tools and Practices (Q12; Q12b, Q13, Q13b)

Q12. Has used these financial tools or practices



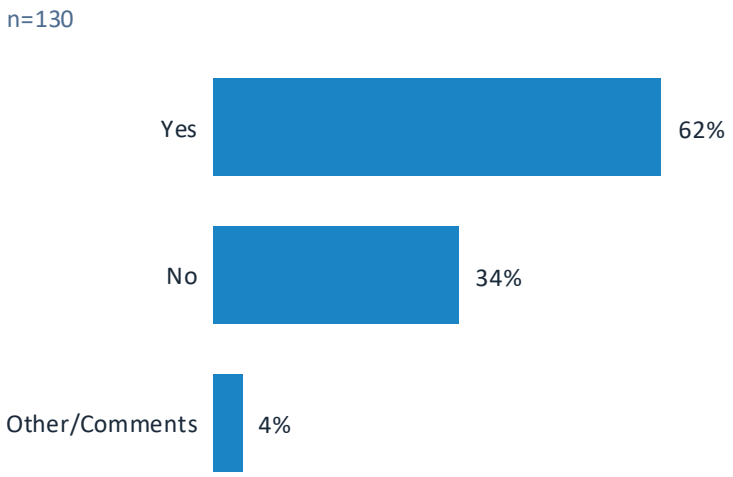
Q12. Notes:

JW: The building blocks come first: record keeping, budgets and statements.

Other tools/practices:

- *At 82 I still do a lot of it myself*
- *Developing a yearly budget*
- ****Inventory control*
- *Markets have been tough*
- *Ok*

Q12b. Would training on these be beneficial?

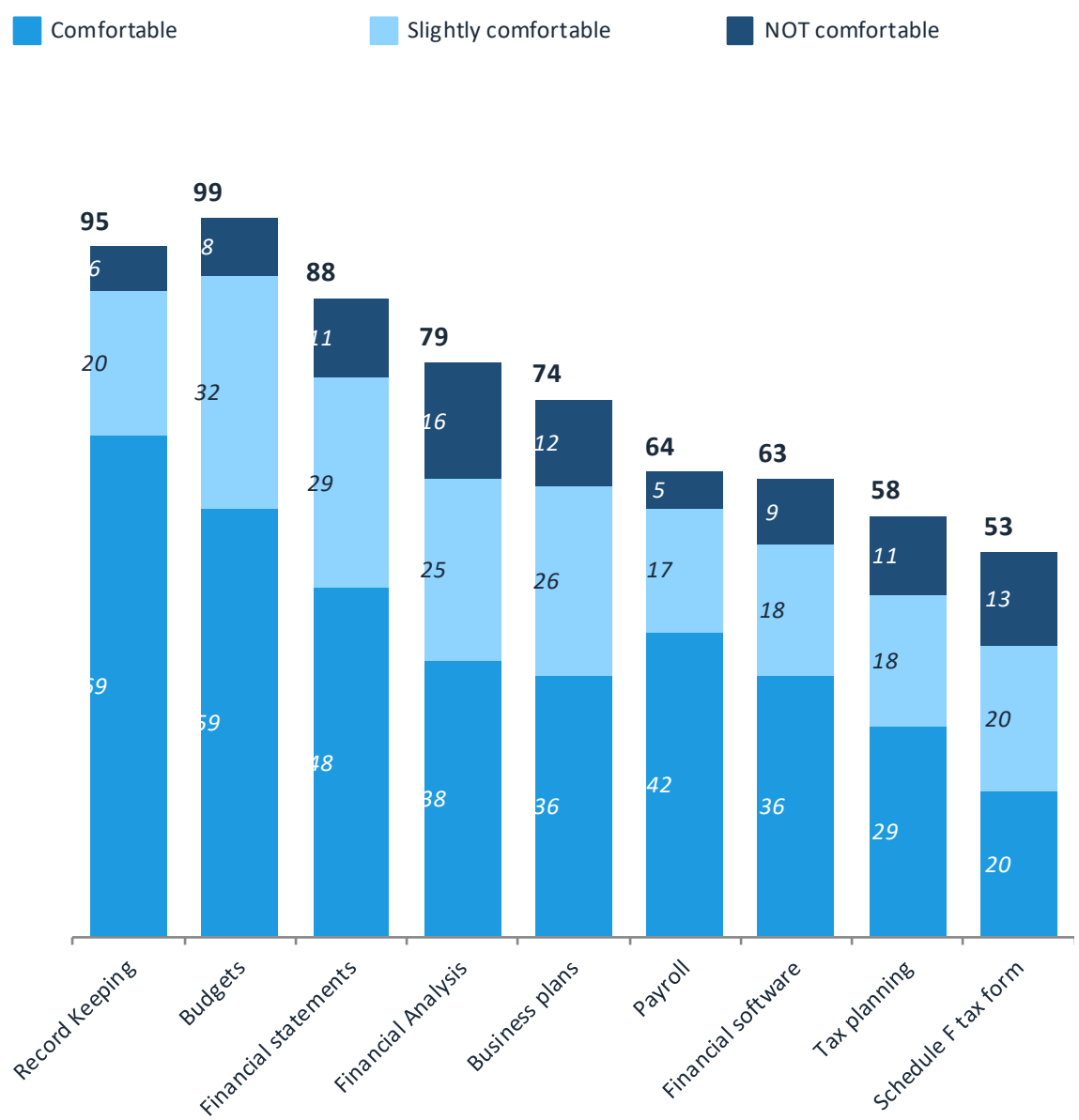


Q12b. Notes:

Other responses:

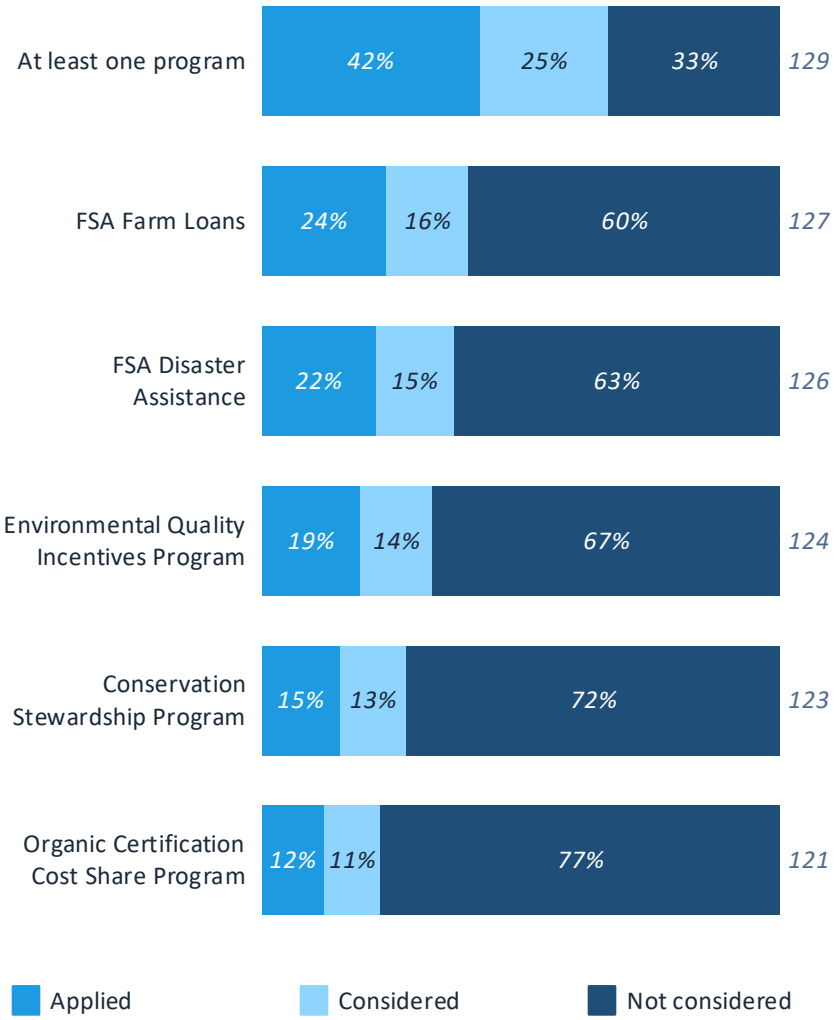
- *Don't have time*
- *I feel comfortable using what I have*
- *I have an accountant*

Q12. Level of Comfort with Financial Tools USED



Financial Tools and Practices

Q13. Have you applied to any of the following federal government programs?



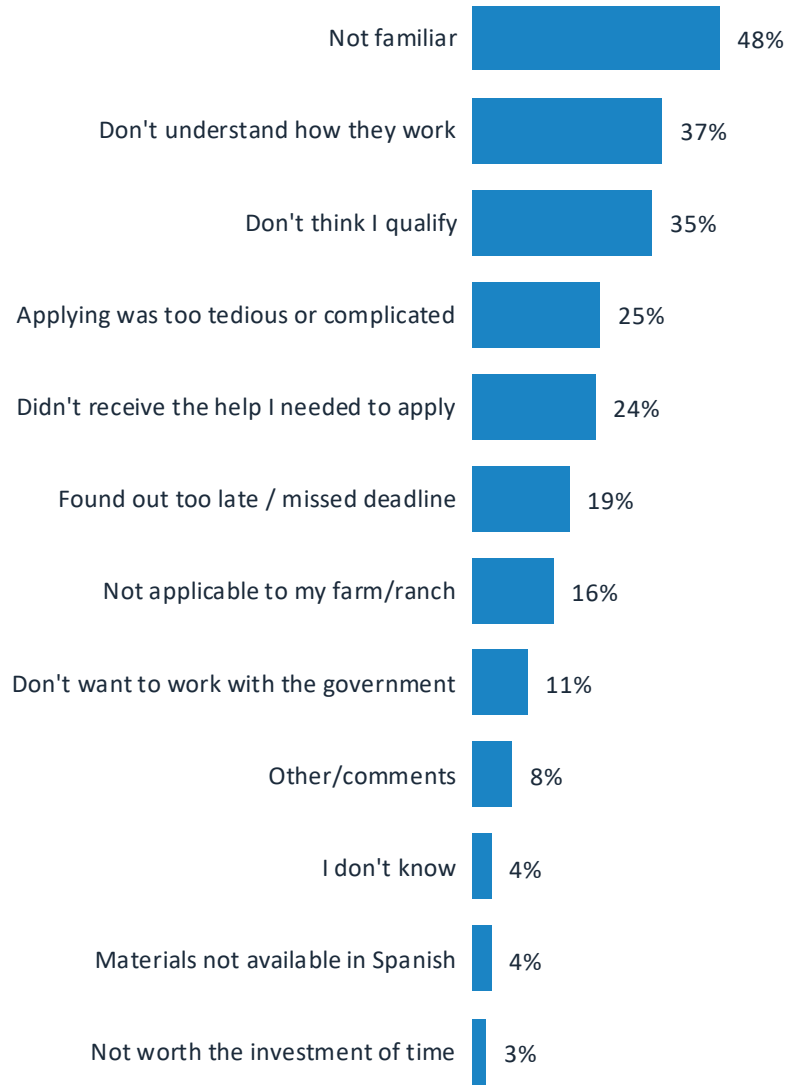
Q13. Notes:

JW: This graph is really telling for the TAPN network.

For those who have not applied…

Q13b. Why haven't you applied for these federal government programs?

n=75



Q13b. Notes:

DR: If we did focus groups, ask why. Look at subsample by language and farm size.

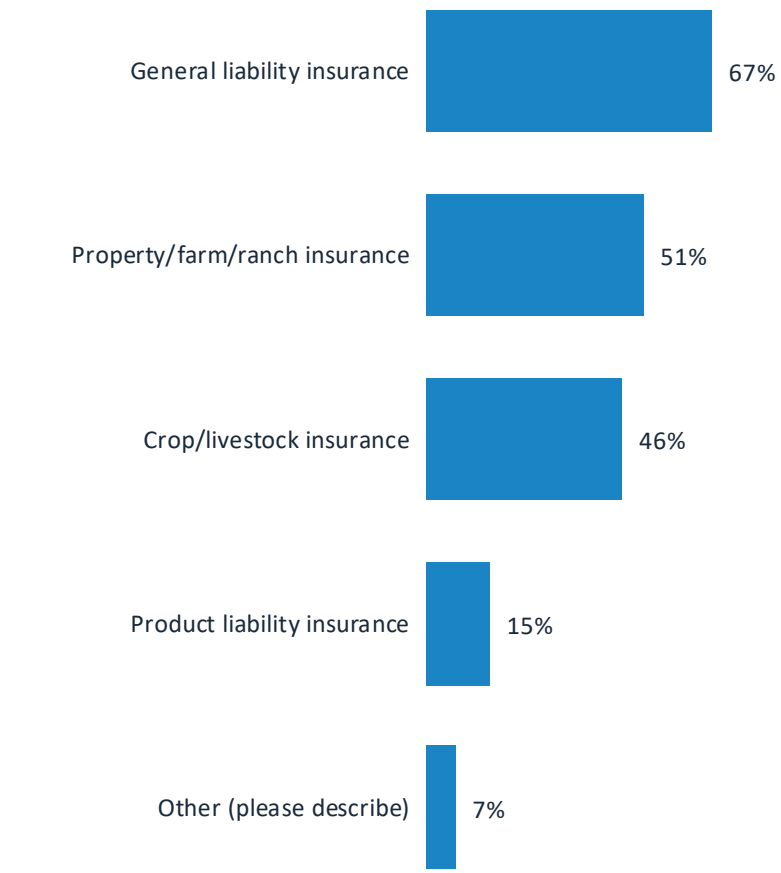
Other reasons:

- *Adjusted gross income too high*
- *USDA loan form was too long*
- *Did not qualify*
- *I have applied*
- *Not enough funds to match*
- *Programs geared to larger farms*

Insurance (Q14; Q14b, Q14c, Q14d)

Q14. Have you used any of the following insurance?

n=104



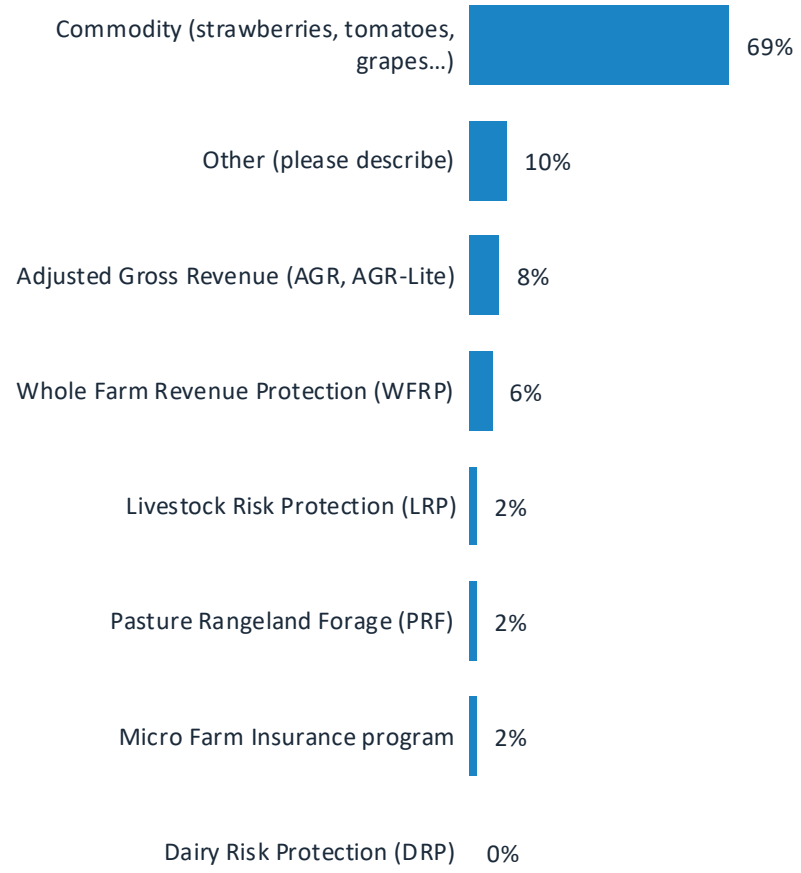
Q14. Notes:

Other responses:

- *Don't have money*
- *No*
- *NAP*
- *None*
- *There is no insurance for my crop*
- *Livestock only*

Q14b. What type of crop/livestock insurance have you used?

n=48



Q14b. Notes:

Other types:

- *Alfalfa seed insurance*
- *Almond crop insurance*
- *Nationwide insurance*
- *Not sure*
- *Rainfall insurance*

Insurance

Q14c. Why have you not used crop/livestock insurance?

n=56



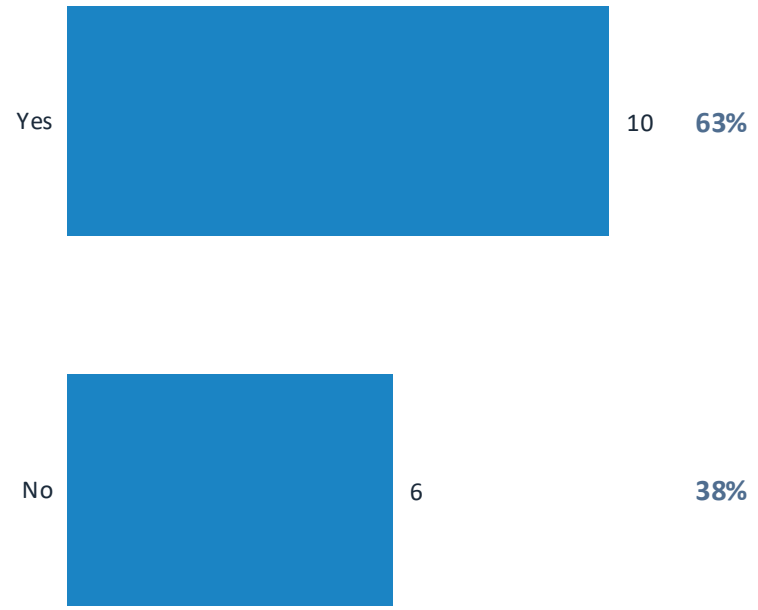
Q14c. Notes:

Other responses:

- *Not available for cannabis*
- *Too expensive*

Q14d. Is product liability insurance required by your buyers?

n=16

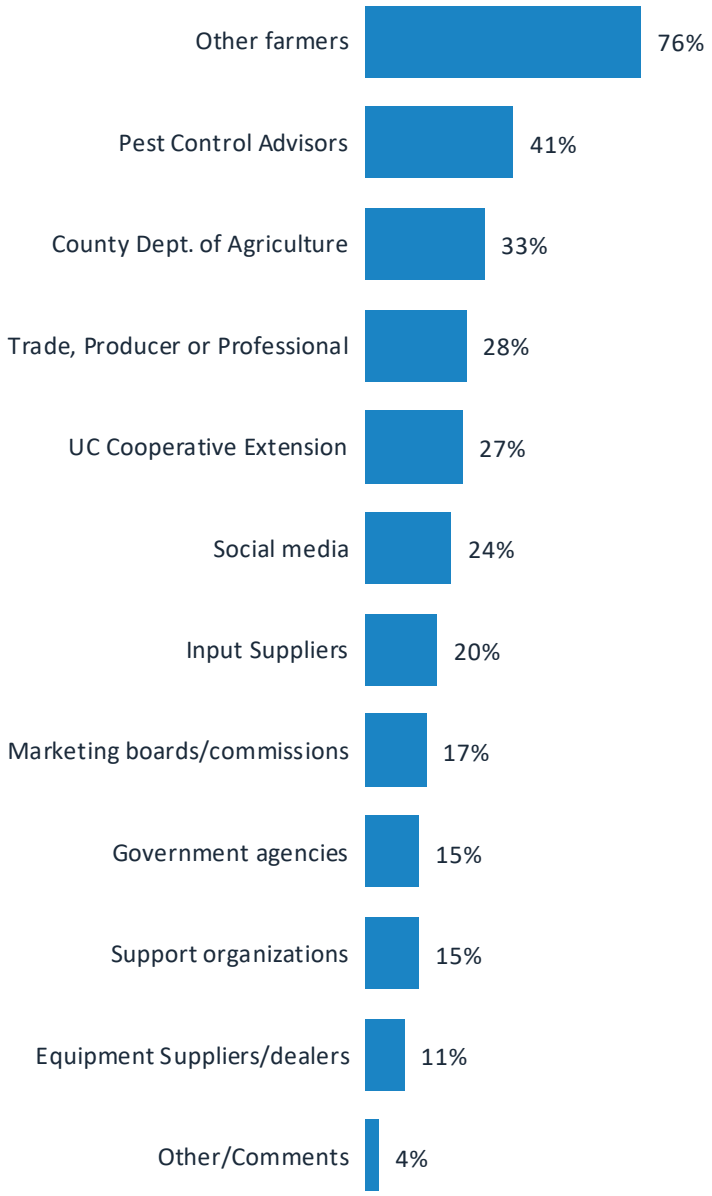


Q14d. Notes:

Information Needs (Q28; Q29)

Q28. Who are your main sources of agricultural information?

n=123



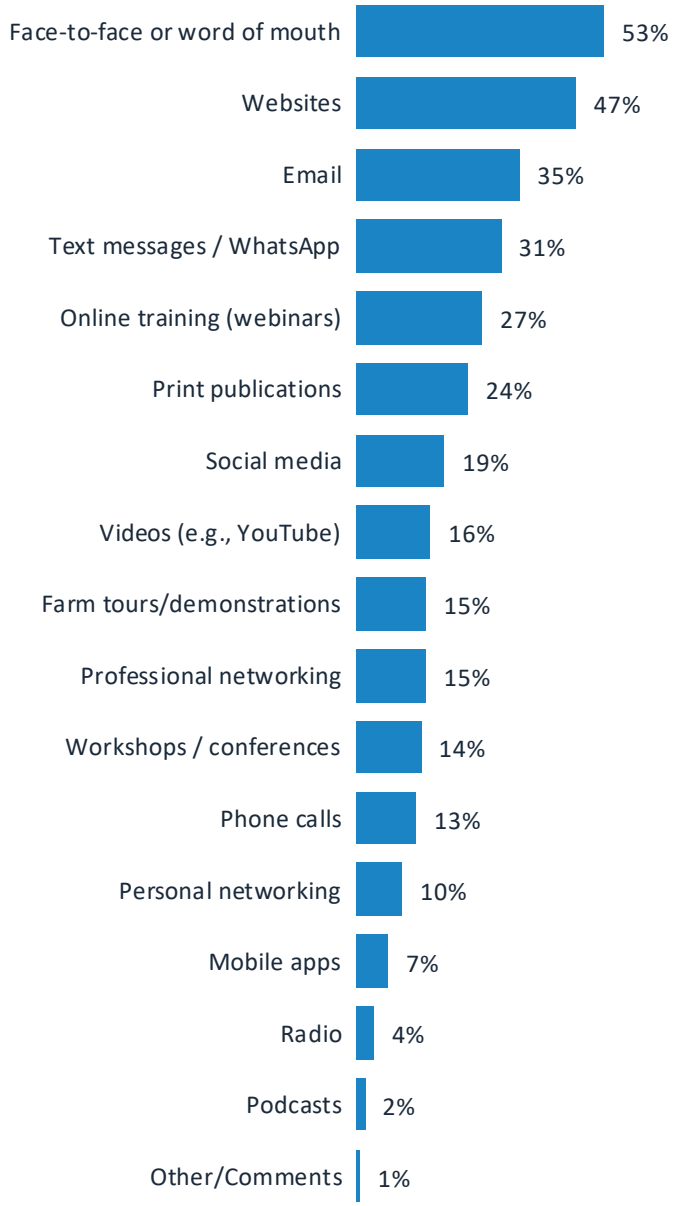
Q28. Notes:

Other Sources:

- *Articles in ag publications*
- *California Farm Bureau*
- *North Coast growers' association*
- *Periodicals / magazines*
- *Personal knowledge*

Q29. What are your preferred method(s) to receive agricultural information?

n=124



Q29. Notes:

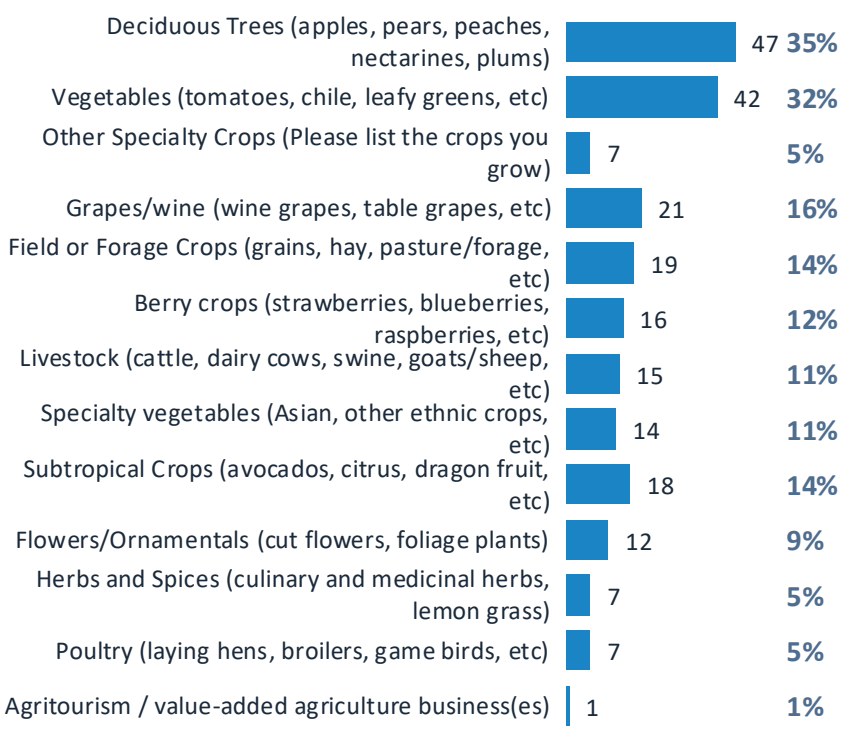
Other Method:

- *Mail*

Farm Characteristics (Q3, Q5, Q18, Q19, Q33; Q25; Q26)

Q3. What do you produce on your farm or ranch?

n=133



Q3. Notes:

Sub-sample: annuals vs. perennials.

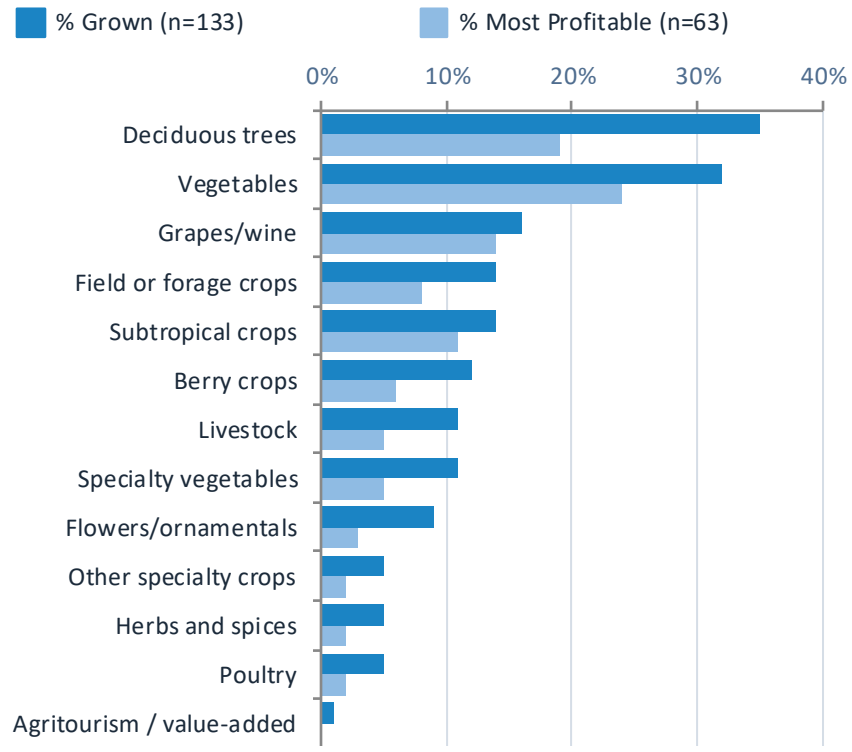
New Variable: Crop Type Diversity (avg. 1.7 categories per farm).

Other Products:

- *Agave for spirits and mezcal*
- *Almonds & walnuts (2)*
- *Avocados (2)*
- *Bee hives*
- *Bermuda grass hay*

Q3 & Q5. What is produced & generates the most profit

n=133 grown / 63 profit



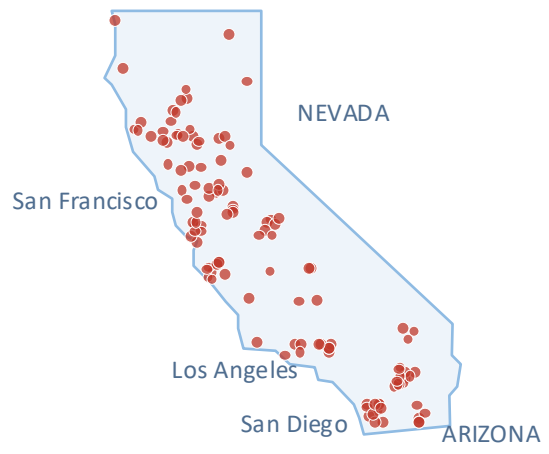
Q3. & Q5. Notes:

% Grown uses n=133 (select all that apply).

% Most Profitable uses n=63 (select one).

Q33. What is the zip code for your primary farm and ranch location?

n=121

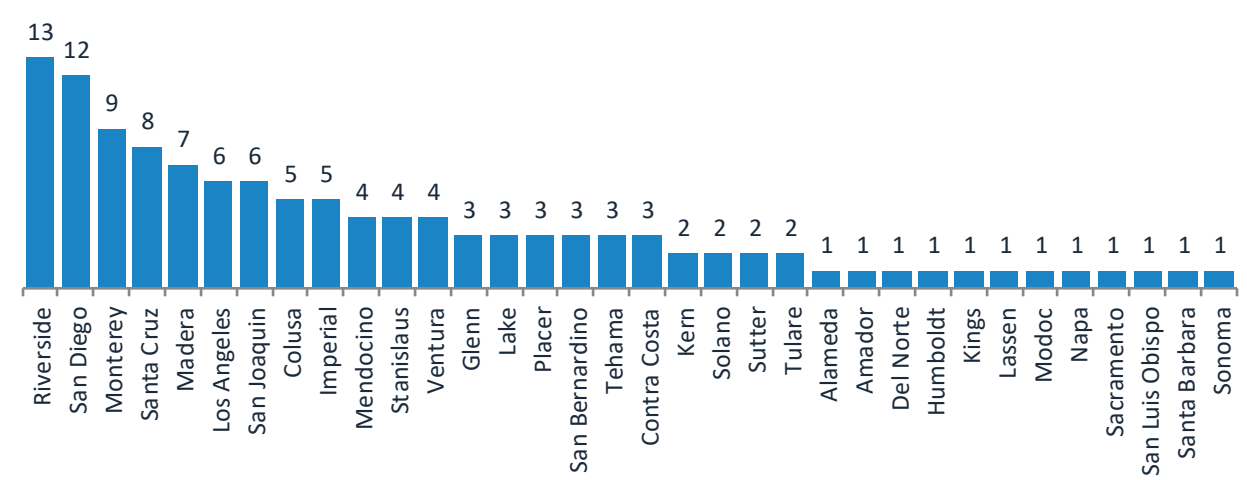


Q33. Notes:

RL: Organize map by CDFA Regions and subsample by regions.

Q33. Survey Respondents by County

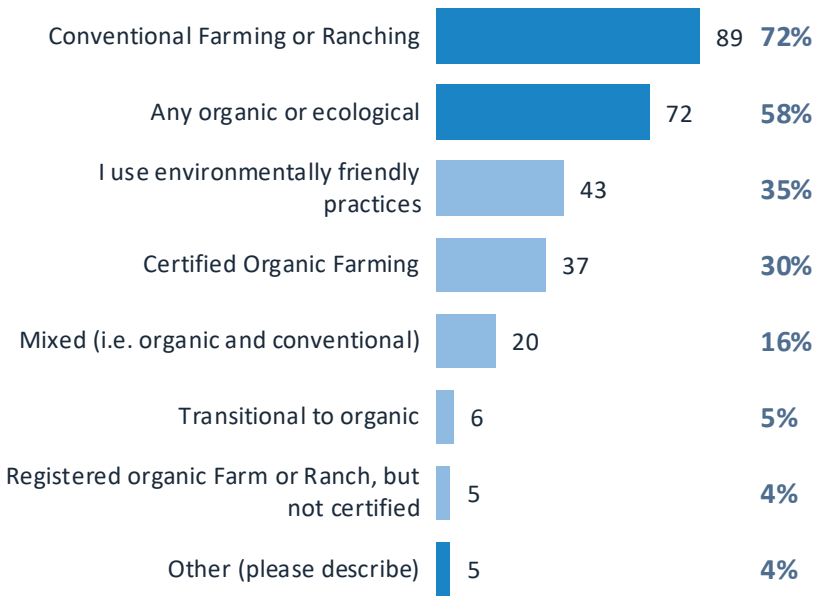
n=121



Farm Characteristics

Q18. What production systems best describe your operation?

n=124



Q18. Notes:

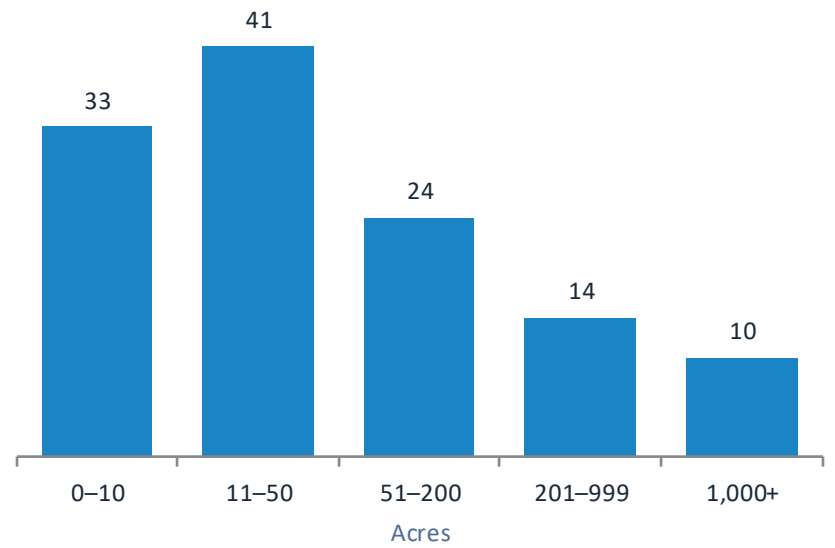
Make a New variable: any organic or ecological (72 of 124; 37 certified, 35 not).

Other Systems:

- *Indoor greenhouse farming*
- *Not certified, regenerative organic*
- *Regenerative farm*
- *Hydroponics*

Q19. Total acres

n=122



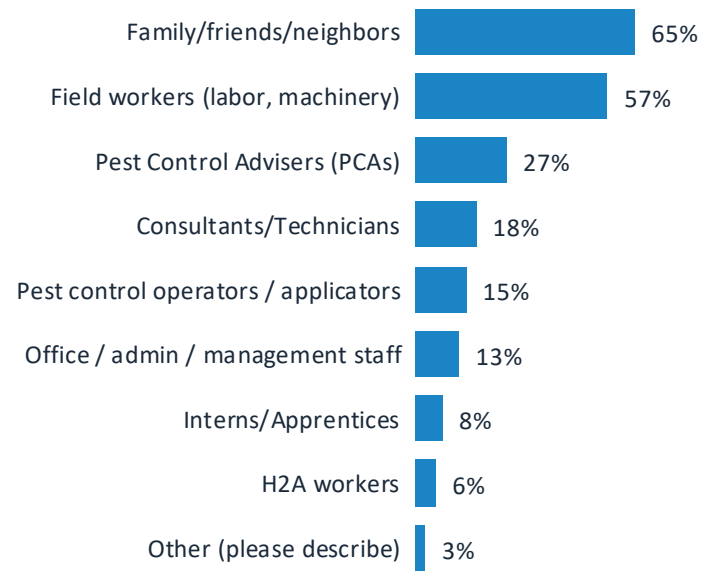
Q19. Notes:

RL: Correlation between acres and number of workers.

RL: Land tenure vs. production system.

Q25. What type(s) of help/labor do you use on your farm/ranch?

n=124



Q25. Notes:

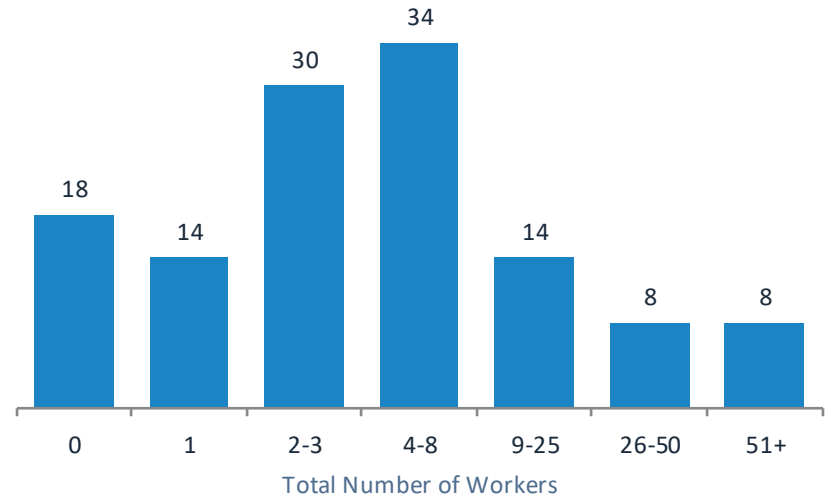
Make New variable: those who use only family/friends and which don't have field workers (34 of 124, 27%).

Other Types:

- *College students only*
- *Day laborers*
- *We have a farm manager*

Q26. Total Workers

n=126



Q26. Notes:

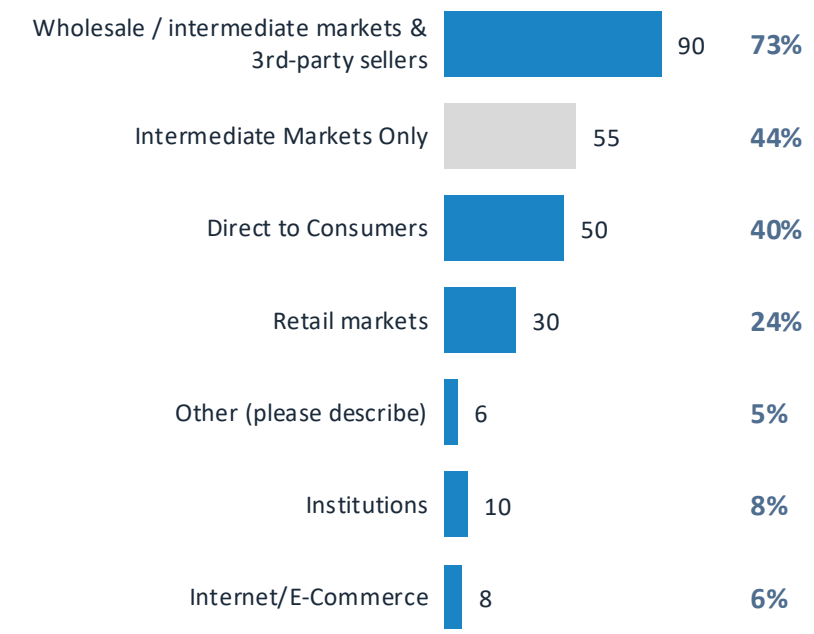
Also have part time vs. full time.

Subsample: farms with 9+ workers (n=30).

Farm Economics (Q22, Q23, Q19c, Q15; Q27, Q27b, Q24, Q24b)

Q22-How do you sell your products?

n=124



Q22. Notes:

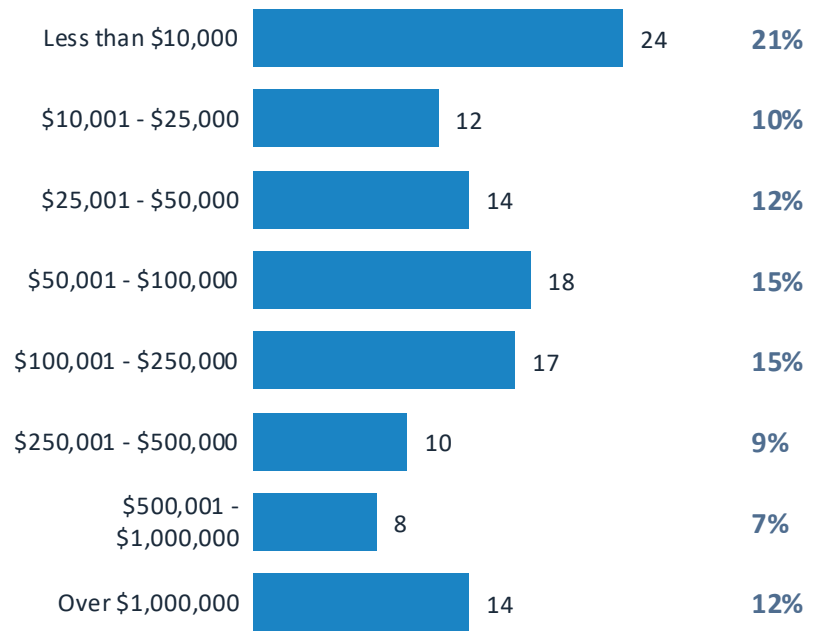
NP: Create a new variable for intermediate markets only (gray bar).

Other Ways:

- *Donations to Feeding America*
- *Foodshed coop*
- *I don't sell at this time*
- *My farm is newer with no sales yet*
- *People come to my farm*

Q23. Which of the following best describes the total annual sales from your farm or ranch? (in US $)

n=117

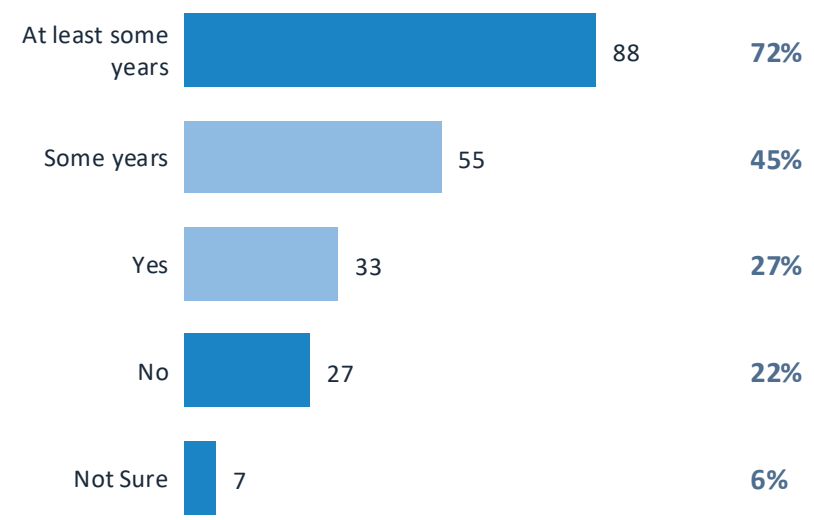


Q23. Notes:

Subsample: USDA definitions (small farms).

Q27. Is your farm/ranch profitable?

n=122

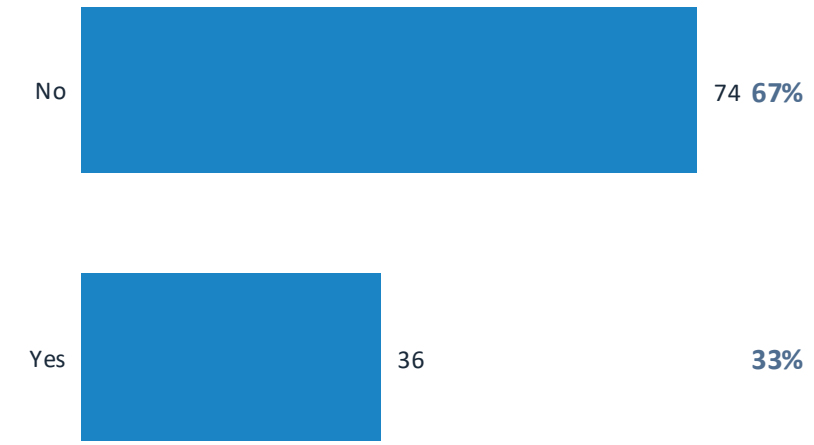


Q27. Notes:

At least some years = Some years + Yes.

Q27b. In your "production costs" above, do you include compensation for your own time or work on your farm or ranch?

n=110

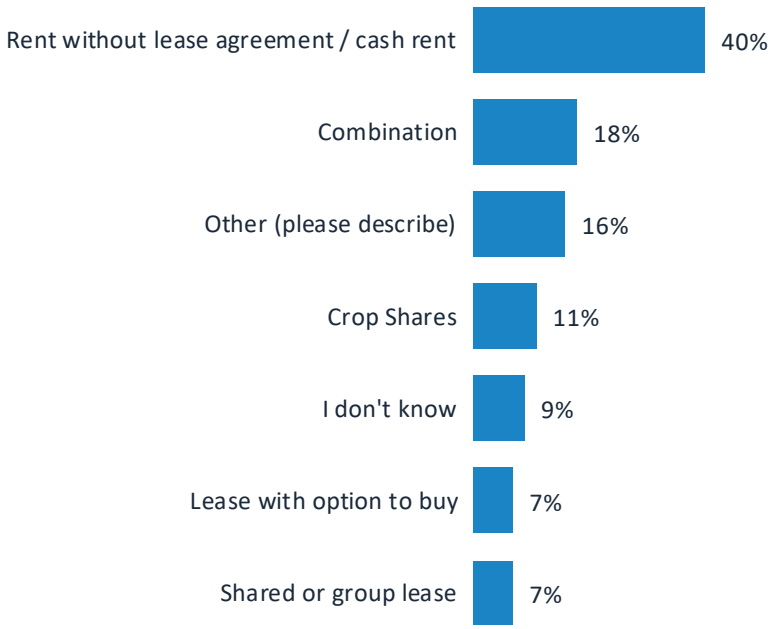


Q27b. Notes:

Farm Economics

Q19c. What type(s) of lease agreements do you use?

n=45



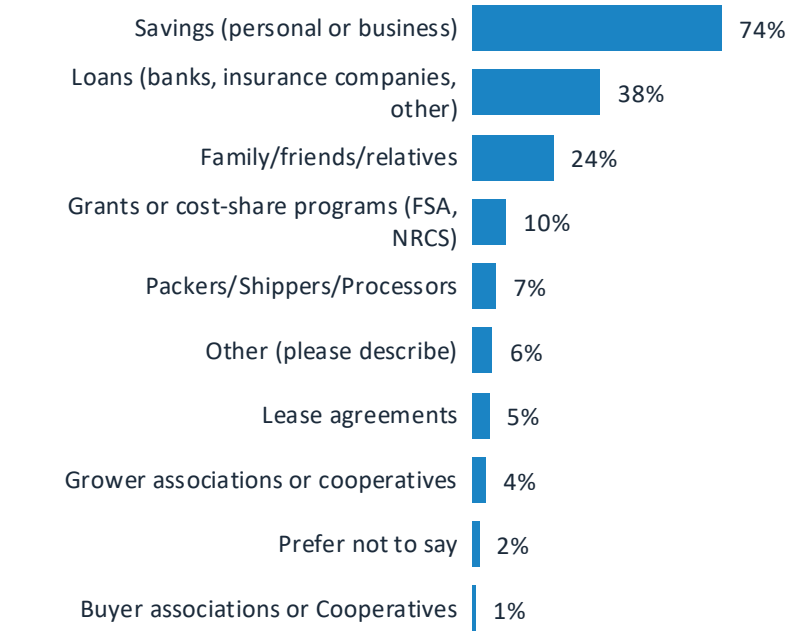
Q19c. Notes:

Other Types:

- *1-year annual renewal*
- *3 yr lease*
- *Cash lease*
- *Gross income percentage*
- *Lease with cash rent*
- *Rent with rental agreement*
- *Triple net two years lease*

Q15. What have been your primary sources of funding for your farm or ranch?

n=130



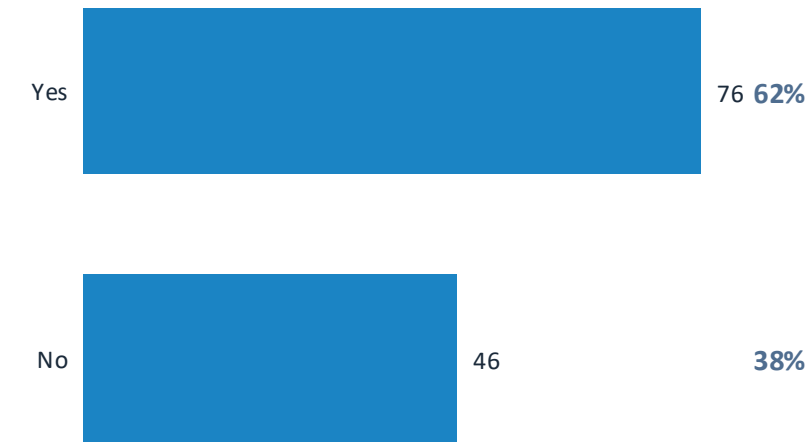
Q15. Notes:

Other Sources:

- *Farming revenues*
- *I donate a lot of produce*
- *Other business*
- *Other source of income*
- *Partners in limited partnership*
- *Production sales*
- *The little money the farm makes*

Q24. Is your household supported by any off-farm or off-ranch income?

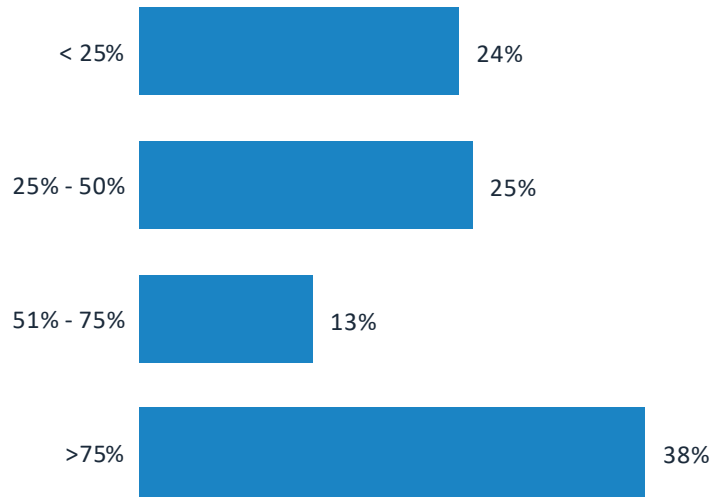
n=122



Q24. Notes:

Q24b. Approximately what percentage of total household income is from an off-farm or off-ranch source?

n=76

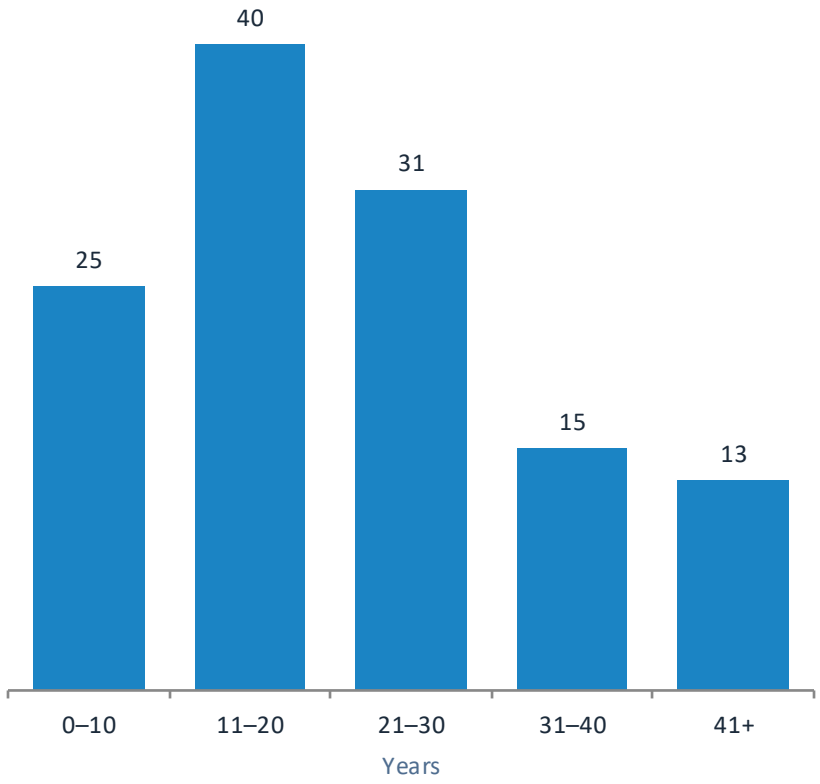


Q24b. Notes:

Farming Background (Q32, Q20, Q37)

Q32. Years Farming

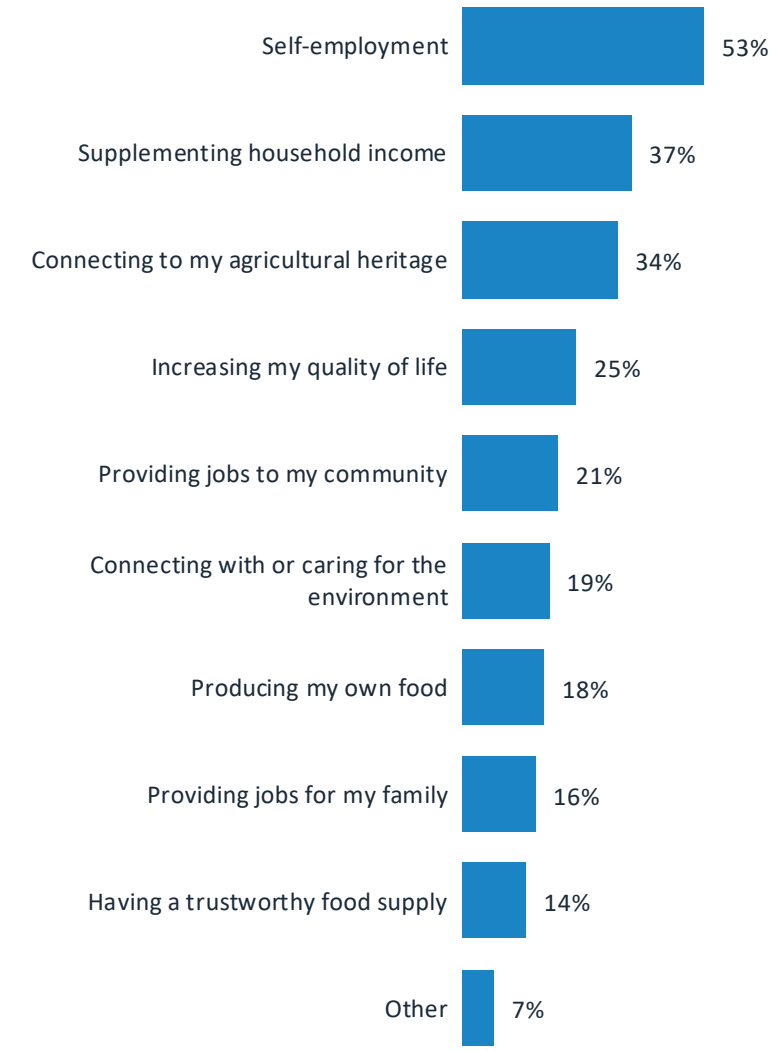
n=124



Q32. Notes:

Q20-What are the primary reasons why you farm or ranch?

n=123



Q20. Notes:

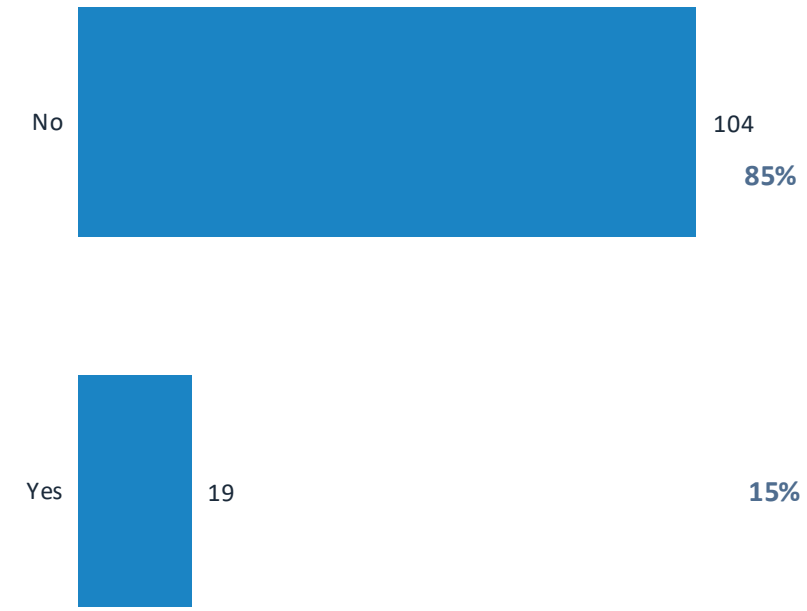
Other Reasons:

- *Came with country property*
- *I am a professional agricultural worker*
- *I enjoy it, keeps me busy*
- *I love it. It makes me happy*
- *Manage farm operations*
- *My husband and I own it*
- *Profitability*
- *This is all I know how to do*

Farming Background

Q37. Have you ever participated in a formal beginning farmer program?

n=123

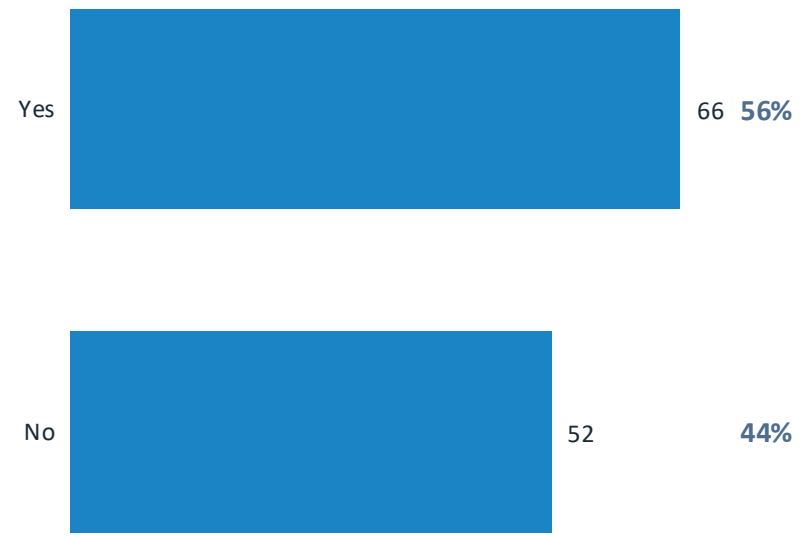


Q37. Notes:

Demographics (Q31, Q31b, Q30, Q34, Q35, Q36)

Q31. Were you born in the United States (US)?

n=118

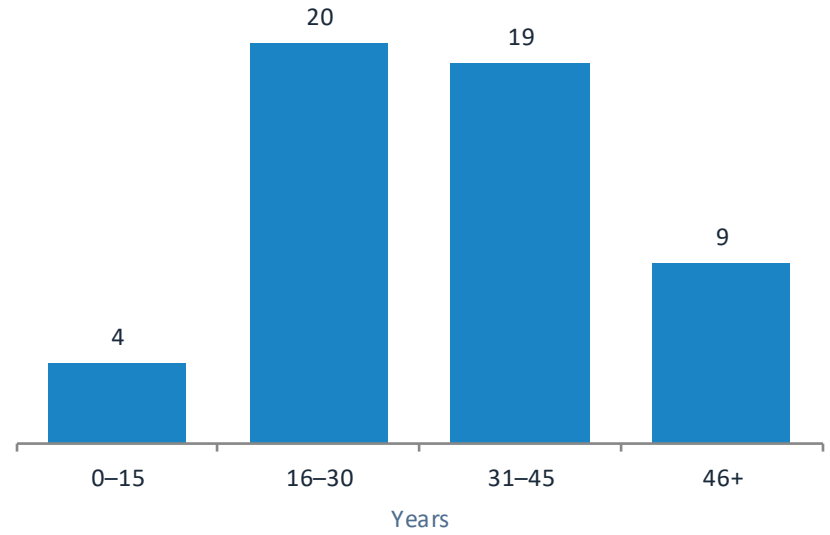


Q31. Notes:

Subsample: immigrants.

Q31b. Years in the US

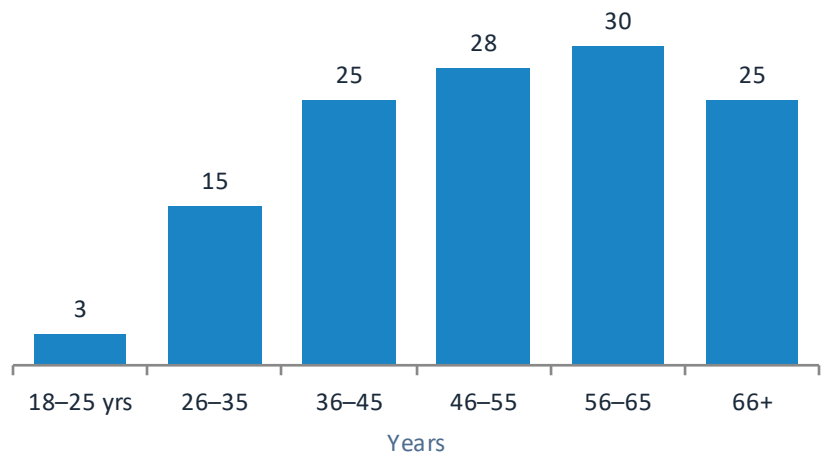
n=52



Q31b. Notes:

Q34. Age

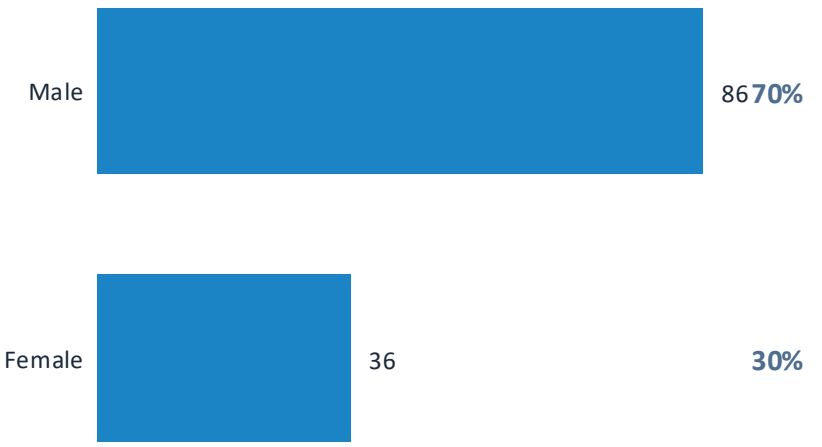
n=126



Q34. Notes:

Q35-What is your gender?

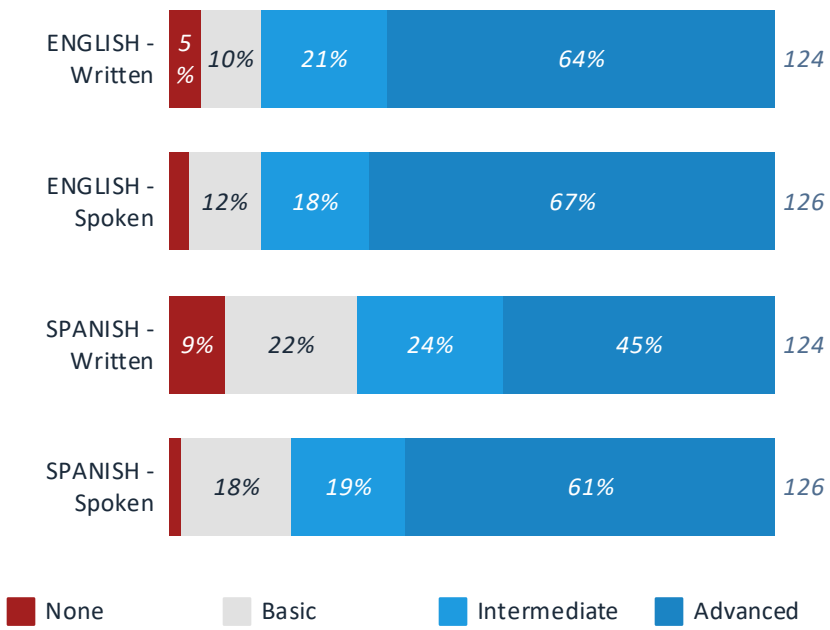
n=122



Q35. Notes:

Demographics

Q30. Language Proficiency

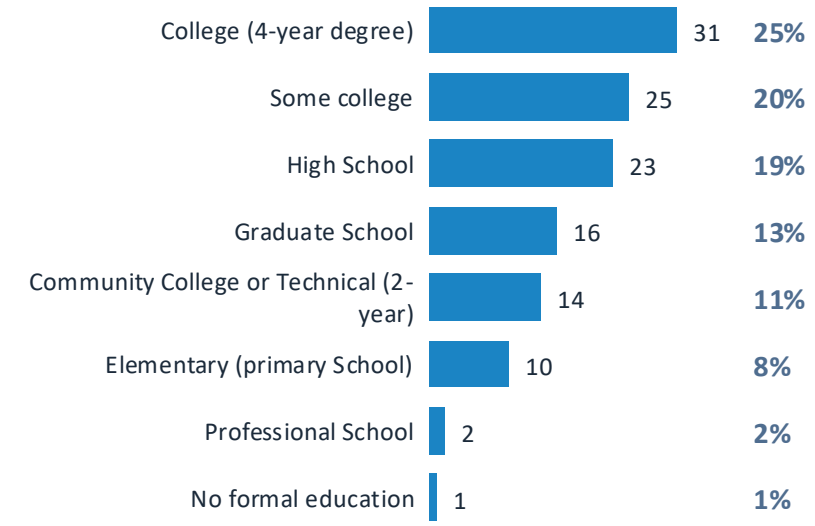


Q30. Notes:

Subpopulation: basic English.

Q36. Highest level of education.

n=122



Q36. Notes: